MARKET REPORT

SEWANG LIQUOR · WEEKLY

SPECIAL

Year-end deposits & cancellation fees

2026.11.4 · 2 min

One no-show costs KRW 443,000, only 14% take deposits

First year-end under the 40% group-booking penalty cap — a one-page booking notice

Your year-end booking notice: **three lines** to write before the menu. The copy-and-paste sample is in **04**.

① Deposit	② Refund	③ End time
How much	By when	What time

FIRST YEAR-END

THREE NUMBERS THIS ISSUE

65%	Restaurants hit by a no-show in the past 3 years (214 surveyed nationwide)
14%	Shops that take a deposit
40%	No-show penalty cap for group bookings — if disclosed in advance

Ministry of SMEs and Startups survey, Jan 2026 · KFTC 2026.1.5

×4.9 Instagram 'year-end party' posts, Oct→Nov (2025 · Sometrend). Post your booking notice **this week, before the inquiries pile in**.

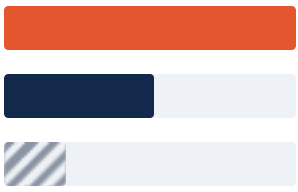
↓ Scroll down · no PDF needed

01 WHAT ONE NO-SHOW COSTS

No-shows are common, safeguards are rare

443,000 KRW

Average loss per no-show. Shops that were hit averaged **8.6** no-shows in 3 years.



HOW TO READ

Bars show the highest (Japanese), Korean and the lowest (chicken) of 6 cuisine types. A nationwide survey of 214 shops — not Seoul figures, and every shop differs.

95%
Take bookings by phone — no record left

14%
Take a deposit — 1 or 2 shops in 10

Source Ministry of SMEs and Startups, 'Small-business no-show damage survey', Jan 2026 (Aju Business Daily) / Asia Today 2026.2.4

02

THE STANDARD CHANGED

KakaoTalk quiz answer

Group-booking no-show penalty, 10% to 40%

40%

Penalty cap as a share of the total bill — the standard changed early this year; **this year-end is the first under it**.

10% **Before the revision** — 2018 standard (as reported)

20% **General restaurants** — from Jan 2026

40% **Group & reservation-based restaurants** — new from Jan 2026 · quiz answer ③

Only if disclosed in advance

Does not apply if you did not state it when taking the booking

HOW TO READ

The Consumer Dispute Resolution Standards (KFTC) are advisory criteria for mediation — not binding rules, and not legal advice. 'Total bill' is the total agreed at booking.

DISPUTE A KRW 100,000 deposit, **cancelled 7 days ahead, refund**

refused as a 'no-show' (reported Dec 2025). Without a refund deadline, the deposit becomes the dispute.

Source KFTC 2026.1.5 (original) / Food Journal 2018.2.28 / E-Today 2026.5.13 / Seoul Economic Daily 2025.12.20

03

29 SHOPS WITH PUBLISHED RULES

Deposits KRW 10–30k per person · '2 days before' is the line

20,000 KRW

Median of the 5 shops with a readable amount, among 29 in Seoul and Pangyo. **28 of the 29 take a deposit.**



100%	50%	0%	10–30 min
Up to 2 days before	1 day before	Same day · no-show	Late → cancelled

Ladder figures follow 2 of the 7 shops · all 7 draw the line at '2 days before'
12 state same-day / no-show forfeiture

28/29	0 shops	0 shops
Take a deposit	'n% of total' penalty type	Mention the KFTC 20·40%

HOW TO READ

Public wording copied from booking apps, blogs and Instagram; addresses checked on KakaoMap. 28 are booking-app shops (mostly Western / fine dining) — this shows the type of shop that publishes rules, not adoption rates.

Source Sewang AI Center shop survey, 29 shops (2026.11.1) — no names or branches · no phone or on-site verification. Ask your sales rep for details.

04

ONE-PAGE BOOKING NOTICE · TO-DO

The three lines that go before the menu

3 lines

Deposit · refund deadline · end time. Copy it and change **only the amounts and times**.

COPY & USE

[December group bookings open]

· Groups of 6+: deposit **KRW 20,000 per person** — deducted from the bill on arrival

· Cancellation: **full refund up to 2 days before** · 50% 1 day before · no refund on the day or for a no-show without notice

(On a no-show the deposit is not refunded and is kept as the cancellation fee — within the Consumer Dispute Resolution Standards cap of 40% of the total bill · advisory standard)

· Bookings may be cancelled automatically **20 minutes** after the reserved time

· **Starts 6pm · ends 9pm** course KRW ○○ (one main: Hanwoo sirloin or abalone) · meal-only also available

· Book: Naver Booking / phone 02-○○○ (confirmation text sent once the deposit is received)

Copy the notice

HOW TO READ

The Korean original can be copied from the KO page (first button in the language switcher at the top). KRW 20,000 is the survey median; the refund ladder follows 2 surveyed shops. Keep the deposit under 40% of the total bill (at KRW 50,000 per head, KRW 20,000 per person is the cap). Not legal advice.

- [ ] **Deposit line — 'KRW 20,000 per person · deducted from the bill'**
  For phone bookings, put the same sentence in the confirmation text (a record of advance disclosure)

- [ ] **Refund line + one penalty line**
  'Full refund 2 days before · 50% 1 day before · none on the day' + 'on a no-show the deposit is kept as the cancellation fee (within the 40% cap)'

- [ ] **Time line — 'starts 6pm · ends 9pm'**
  A course with a visible end time · meal-only also available

- [ ] **Hang up on 'buy the liquor in advance' calls**
  Liquor only through the sales rep you already deal with

SCAM ALERT "Buy the liquor in advance from ○○ liquor shop" —

callers pushed bank transfers, then vanished: **5 restaurants, KRW 12.88 million** (verdict reported Jan 2026).

Source Shop survey, 29 shops / KFTC 2026.1.5 / Korea Economic Daily 2026.1.5 / Hot Pepper Gourmet Gaishoku Soken, Nov 2025 (61.5% prefer 'start 18–19:00 · end 21:00'). For products, prices and draft-beer certification, ask your sales rep.

05

CALENDAR · NEXT ISSUE · SALES REPS

First week of November

11/4
Wednesday

This issue
The week to post the three lines

11/11
Wednesday

Next issue
See 'Next issue' below

12/11 12/18
Friday

Fridays of Dec weeks 2 & 3
'Nearly full' as of early October (Gonggam News 10/5) — point remaining Fridays and weekdays to your notice

ASK YOUR SALES REP · THIS WEEK

1. First-drink and pairing items for group courses (small bottles · traditional liquor · base whisky for highballs)
2. A small welcome-drink set for booked guests
3. When the year-end liquor lineup changes

SHARE

Send this to owners in your area

When shops in the same area use similar notices, guests come to see deposits as normal.

Send the link to the owner next door

☕ Share to enter automatically · weekly coffee voucher draw (valid when someone opens your link · winners leave a phone number in the next issue)

NEXT ISSUE · Wed, Nov 11

The year-end party clock — what time it starts, what time it ends

Team-dinner time slots, demand by age group, 'a course with a visible end time' — planned (topic not yet final).

Add our KakaoTalk channel — get the next issue

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Sewang Trading Co., Ltd. · 010-3964-9290
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Sources (11) −

01 KFTC policy briefing 2026.1.5, 'Restaurant no-shows: dispute standards clarified' — general restaurants: no-show penalty up to 20% of total bill / reservation-based restaurants and group bookings (new): up to 40% / applies only when disclosed in advance (original checked)

02 Ministry of SMEs and Startups, 'Small-business no-show damage survey', released 2026.1.1 (Aju Business Daily) — 2025.11.24–12.10, 214 restaurants nationwide. No-show experience 65%, affected

shops 8.6 per 3 years on average (Japanese 16.3 · Coffee 13.5 · Western 10.0 · Korean 8.4 · Chinese 5.6 · Chicken 3.5), average loss KRW 443,000 per no-show, deposits in use 14%

03 Asia Today 2026.2.4 — phone bookings 95% · deposits 14% (citing the MSS survey)

04 Food Journal 2018.2.28, 'Curbing restaurant no-shows: cancel at least 1 hour ahead for a deposit refund' — previous restaurant standard (in force 2018.2.28)

05 E-Today 2026.5.13, '230 no-shows, and only the restaurant cried' — describes the no-show penalty as 'previously up to 10% of the total bill'

06 Seoul Economic Daily 2025.12.20 (via Nate), 'Cancelled a week ahead, still called a no-show — KRW 100,000 deposit kept' — dispute case (JTBC, 2025.12.19; no shop named)

07 Korea Economic Daily 2026.1.5, 'Booked a team dinner for 31, then no-show' — scam ring pockets KRW 13 million — 2025.6.22–7.3, 5 restaurants, KRW 12.88 million; callers pushed bank transfers to 'pre-buy liquor from a designated shop'; 6 months in prison, suspended for 2 years

08 Gonggam News 2026.10.5, 'Book year-end group tables from October' — Fridays of December weeks 2 and 3 'nearly full'

09 Hot Pepper Gourmet Gaishoku Soken, 'Reiwa Edition: Ideal Year-End Party Survey' (PR Times 2025.11.27, 1,035 people aged 20–69) — preferred slot 'start around 18–19:00 · end around 21:00' 61.5%

10 Sometrend monthly Instagram post counts — 'year-end party' 2025.10 1,517 → 11 7,446 (×4.9) → 12 41,087, collected 2026.11.1 (Sep–Oct 2026 excluded on suspected collection lag)

11 Shop survey · 29 shops in Seoul and Pangyo that publish deposit rules (2026.11.1) — excerpts from booking-app shop pages ('Booking info'), Naver blogs and Instagram notices, addresses checked on KakaoMap. Take a deposit 28, amount readable 5 (10k · 15k · 20k · 30k · 30k), refund ladder 7 (all drawing the line at 2 days before), same-day / no-show forfeiture stated 12, 'n% of total' type 0, KFTC standard mentioned 0, late auto-cancel 5 (10–30 min). No phone or on-site verification

※ Shops are identified by type and area only, no names or branches. Rules are as publicly posted at the time and may change. The 'shop survey' is not an official statistic. The Consumer Dispute Resolution Standards are advisory and this report is not legal advice.

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